



University Students' Perceptions of AI Fortune-Telling: An Exploratory Study on Credibility and Motivations

Wu Caiyan (Eden), 124090709

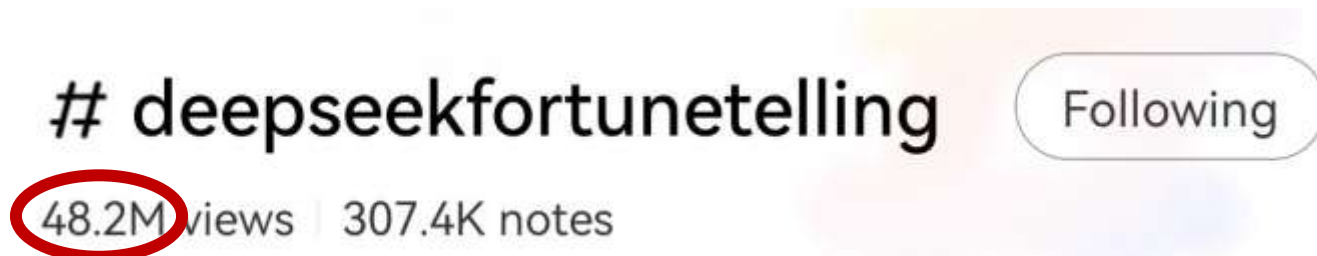


Introduction

➤ *What is AI fortune-telling?*



➤ *Popularity of AI fortune-telling*



Literature Review & Research Gap

➤ *University students & Traditional fortune-telling*

- Main online fortune-telling/divination seekers use tools for uncertainty relief
- They know it can't predict the future or fully accept its results. (Dong, 2010; Wang & Tai, 2025)

Under-examine university students' perceptions of AI fortune-telling

➤ *Young people & AI fortune-telling*

- Prefer AI fortune-telling methods over traditional ones (Lai & Zhou, 2023)
- Psychological factors influence belief in AI predictions (Lee et al., 2024)

Lack the demographic focus on university students

Research Questions



What are the major motivations that drive university students to use AI fortune-telling tools?



To what extent do university students believe in the accuracy and reliability of AI fortune-telling?

Methods

➤ *Participants*

97 university students, 45 of them have used AI fortune-telling (3 of them were chosen for interviews)

➤ *Data collection & analysis*

- Questionnaire:

Basic details, usage habits, motivation measurement, perceived credibility assessment

- Interviews:

Previous AI fortune-telling experiences, motivations, perceptions on predictions

Clean and organize data:
Descriptive statistics &
reliability tests (SPSS)

Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
1	2	3	4	5

Categorize recorded content
into different patterns

Findings

➤ *Part 1: Motivations*

Dimension	N	Mean	SD	Importance Ranking
Curiosity	45	3.78	0.85	3
Alleviating anxiety about future development	45	3.11	1.15	5
Obtain emotional support	45	3.29	1.18	4
Recommendations from others	45	2.93	1.14	6
“Algorithmic objectivity” of AI fortune-telling	45	2.62	0.98	7
Accessibility	45	3.84	1.15	2
Convenience	45	4.04	0.98	1

Accessibility

Convenience

Services can be easily used

Services can be easily obtained

Table 1: Motivations of users and Descriptive Statistics

- Major motivations: Convenience (most prominent), accessibility and curiosity.

Findings

➤ *Part 2: Perceived Credibility*

Items	N	Mean	SD
16. The results of AI fortune-telling can reflect an individual's real fortune or development trend.	97	2.42	0.97
17. The algorithmic logic of AI fortune-telling is reliable.	97	2.88	0.94
18. AI fortune-telling influences the direction of my decision-making.	97	2.49	1.04
19. Even if there are differences between the results of AI fortune-telling and personal expectations, it still has reference value for me.	97	2.93	1.06
20. Whether an AI fortune-telling tool discloses its algorithmic principles will affect my trust in it.	97	3.26	1.14
21. The results of AI fortune-telling are not affected by subjective factors.	97	2.59	1.01

Table 2. Perceived Credibility of all participants and Descriptive Statistics

- The overall perceived credibility of AI fortune-telling is relatively low.
- Most concerned about algorithm transparency.

Findings

➤ *Part 2: Perceived Credibility*

	I have used AI fortune-telling tools. (Mean $\pm$ SD)		<i>t</i>	<i>p</i>
	Yes (<i>n</i> =45)	No (<i>n</i> =52)		
The results of AI fortune-telling can reflect an individual's real fortune or development trend.	2.58 $\pm$ 0.92	2.29 $\pm$ 1.00	1.479	0.142
The algorithmic logic of AI fortune-telling is reliable.	3.00 $\pm$ 0.83	2.77 $\pm$ 1.02	1.230	0.222
AI fortune-telling influences the direction of my decision-making.	2.67 $\pm$ 1.04	2.35 $\pm$ 1.03	1.521	0.132
Even if there are differences between the results of AI fortune-telling and personal expectations, it still has reference value for me.	3.27 $\pm$ 0.91	2.63 $\pm$ 1.10	3.043	0.003**
Whether an AI fortune-telling tool discloses its algorithmic principles will affect my trust in it.	3.24 $\pm$ 1.13	3.27 $\pm$ 1.16	-0.106	0.916
The results of AI fortune-telling are not affected by subjective factors	2.76 $\pm$ 0.98	2.44 $\pm$ 1.02	1.537	0.128

* $p < 0.05$ ** $p < 0.01$

Table 3. T-test results on perceived credibility between users and non-users

- For “Even if there are differences between the results of AI fortune-telling and personal expectations, it still has reference value for me”, the perception of users was significantly higher than that of non-users.
- No significant differences for other items between the two groups.

Discussion

- *Answer to R.Q.1:* Convenience (most prominent), accessibility and curiosity
- *Answer to R.Q.2:* They have a low level of belief in the accuracy and reliability of AI fortune-telling.

➤ *Similarity:*

- Curiosity (Cheng, 2025; Wang & Tai, 2025)
- Users were willing to use AI-generated results as personal guidance (Lai & Zhou, 2023).

➤ *Difference:*

- People perceived fictitious AI predictions as highly believable (Lee et al., 2024).

Conclusion

➤ *Contribution:*

- Bridge academic gap between AI fortune-telling and university students' psychology
- Help educators/counselors provide better guidance on students' decision-making/stress coping

➤ *Limitations:*

- Small sample size
- Self-reported data: may be biased
- Lack a comparison with traditional fortune-telling

➤ *Future Work:*

- Explore the underlying logic of “users believing in AI fortune-telling results”
- Compare with traditional fortune-telling



Thank You!

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Q & A